



SPACE



Amazon's Kuiper
satellites to get boost
from rival SpaceX

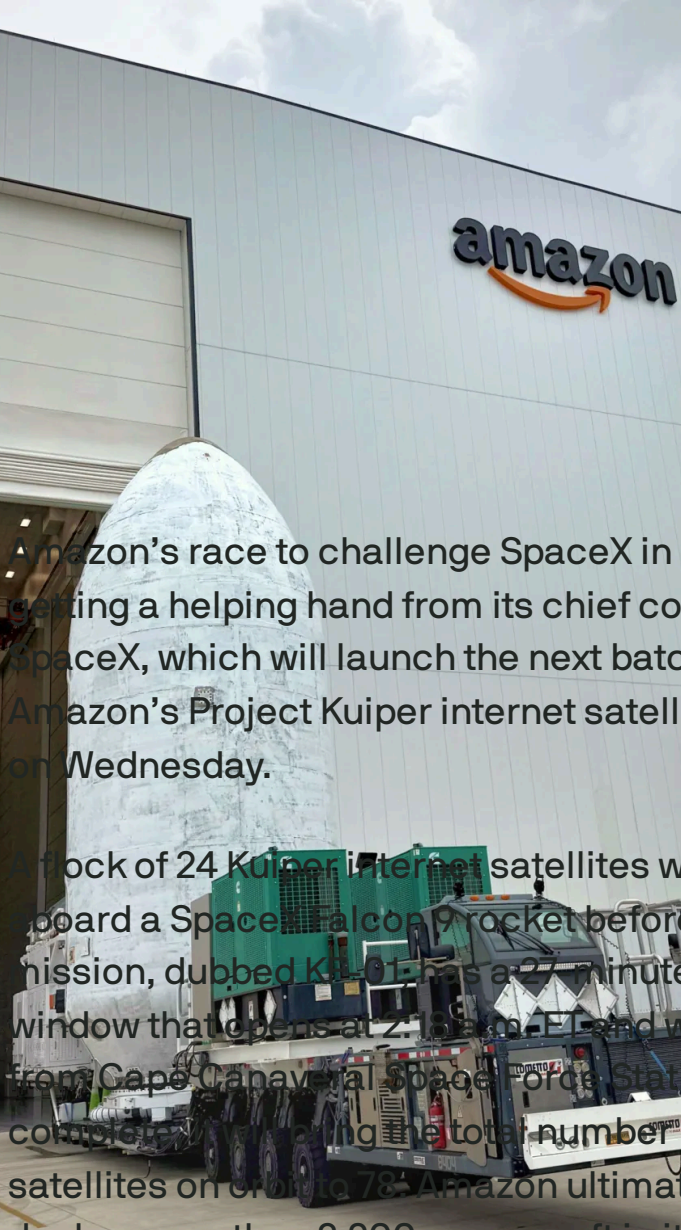


IMAGE CREDITS: [AMAZON](#)

Amazon's race to challenge SpaceX in orbit is getting a helping hand from its chief competitor: SpaceX, which will launch the next batch of Amazon's Project Kuiper internet satellites skyward on Wednesday.

A flock of 24 Kuiper internet satellites will ride aboard a SpaceX Falcon 9 rocket before dawn. The mission, dubbed K1-01, has a 27-minute launch window that opens at 2:13 a.m. ET and will lift off from Cape Canaveral Space Force Station. Once completed, it will bring the total number of Kuiper satellites on orbit to 78. Amazon ultimately plans to deploy more than 3,200 spacecraft in its first-generation constellation in low Earth orbit, aiming to stake a serious claim in the satellite internet market — a market that is currently dominated by Starlink's network of roughly 8,000 satellites.

While Kuiper and SpaceX may make for strange bedfellows, Jeff Bezos' Amazon [inked a three-launch deal](#) with SpaceX back in December 2023. That agreement came scarcely two months after the e-commerce giant [faced a lawsuit](#) from shareholders over an earlier decision not to consider SpaceX when it doled out its first round of lucrative launch contracts, even though the Falcon 9 is the most reliable rocket flying today.

The catch is, at least half of Kuiper's initial constellation must be deployed by the end of July 2026, per its license from the U.S. Federal

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Communications Commission. The clock is ticking: among the other selected launch providers — United Launch Alliance (ULA), Arianespace, and Blue Origin — only ULA has an operational rocket available to carry satellites to orbit. ULA launched the first two batches of Kuiper satellites; the first batch [launched in April](#).

Blue Origin, Bezos' other company, will eventually carry Kuiper satellites on its massive New Glenn rocket, but it has only flown once so far, and it did not manage to recover the booster. The second launch is currently scheduled for August 15.

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Aria Alamalhodaei — 11:53 AM PST · December 1, 2023

Amazon has purchased three Falcon 9 launches from SpaceX to support deployment of its Project Kuiper mega-constellation, the company said Friday. The new deal comes scarcely two months after it was revealed that [Amazon was facing a lawsuit](#) over its decision not to consider SpaceX — the most reliable rocket company on the planet — in its first round of launch contracts.

IMAGE CREDITS: SPACEX

The three Falcon 9 missions are targeted to lift off starting in mid-2025. Kuiper is planning a constellation of 3,236 satellites in low Earth orbit; the U.S. Federal Communications Commission required Amazon to deploy at least half of that figure by 2026.

With the clock ticking, Amazon went ahead and purchased much of the launch capacity through the middle of the decade, securing up to 83 launches from Arianespace, Blue Origin and United Launch Alliance last year at an expected cost of many billions of dollars.

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Amazon shareholders the Cleveland Bakers and Teamsters Pension Fund later filed a suit against the board over this decision, alleging that they spent less than 40 minutes approving the launch agreements while not even considering SpaceX.

The lawsuit further claims that SpaceX was never even floated as a possibility: In July 2020, Amazon management informed its audit committee that the company was in talks with Blue Origin, Arianespace, ULA and a fourth unnamed company for Kuiper launch contracts. “Inexplicably, the most famous, reliable and obvious launch provider in the world — SpaceX — was not among the four companies presented to [Amazon’s] Audit Committee,” the complaint says.

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IMAGE CREDITS: [BLUE ORIGIN](#)

SPACE



Blue Origin looks to take on SpaceX dominance with New Glenn launch days away

Aria Alamalhodaei — 1:23 PM PST · December 30, 2024

Nearly a quarter century after its founding, Jeff Bezos' [Blue Origin](#) is gearing up to launch an orbital rocket for the first time — and finally enter the competitive launch industry that is currently dominated by SpaceX.

Company executives have maintained that they are planning to launch the towering rocket, called New Glenn, before the year is out. However, [an air traffic](#)



[advisory](#) posted last week suggests that Blue Origin may conduct the launch no earlier than January 6.

Regardless, there is little left for the company to do in terms of pre-launch tests or paperwork: Blue Origin received its launch license for New Glenn from federal regulators last week, which authorizes launches for five years. That same day, the company successfully conducted a launch dress rehearsal called a hot fire test. All that's left on the checklist, Blue Origin CEO David Limp [confirmed](#), is connecting the fairing, which carries the rocket's payload.

When the rocket does finally launch, seven of the Blue Origin-made BE-4 engines will fire up to generate over 3.8 million pounds of thrust and propel the rocket away from its launch pad at Cape Canaveral, Florida. The 320-foot-tall rocket will carry demonstrator technology for Blue Origin's Blue Ring spacecraft, an orbital transfer vehicle that's designed to provide transportation, logistics, and satellite servicing.

New Glenn and Blue Ring are just two of several products Blue Origin has been developing to compete in multiple areas of the space industry. The company is ultimately looking to go up against several competitors — not just up against SpaceX's Falcon 9, which currently launches the lion's share of national security and commercial satellite payloads — that are developing [lunar landers](#), [private space stations](#), and more.

Up until this point, Blue Origin has mostly been known for its New Shepard suborbital rocket, which carries space tourists and some cargo up to suborbital space and back in brief flights.

If all goes to plan, New Glenn's booster will return to Earth and land vertically on a floating barge, to be refurbished and reused up to 25 times. NASA also

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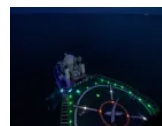


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SpaceX faces two new lawsuits alleging safety-related retaliation

Aria Alamalhodaei

- Jul 30, 2025



tapped Blue Origin to launch twin spacecraft to Mars — those satellites were supposed to fly on this inaugural mission, but after the launch was delayed from October, the space agency [decided to remanifest them on a later New Glenn launch](#). Blue Origin also has signed launch deals with the Space Force, Amazon’s Project Kuiper, and other commercial companies.



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